

The Digital Concierge ROI Calculator

See exactly what you're really paying for your website — and what you could save

By Naoman Saeed · Bespoke Web Engineer

Most wellness professionals think they're saving money by using Squarespace or Wix. They see the \$23/month price tag and think "that's affordable." But that number doesn't tell the whole story.

This calculator reveals the true cost of website builders over 5 years — including platform fees, plugins, developer help, and the hidden cost of lost clients from slow load times. Then it shows you what a hand-coded alternative actually costs.

The results might surprise you.

The Real Cost of Squarespace Over 5 Years

Let's break down what you actually spend when you use a website builder. These are real 2026 numbers based on what wellness professionals typically pay.

Platform Fees (5 Years)

Plan	Monthly Cost	5-Year Total
Squarespace Core (most common)	\$23	\$1,380
Squarespace Plus (advanced features)	\$39	\$2,340
Wix Business	\$39	\$2,340

Essential Add-Ons (Monthly)

Service	Monthly Cost	5-Year Total
Scheduling plugin (Acuity/Calendly)	\$15-20	\$900-1,200
Email marketing (MailerLite/ConvertKit)	\$10-20	\$600-1,200
Premium template (one-time)	\$0	\$100-200
Domain renewal	\$1-2	\$60-120
Total Add-Ons (5 years)		\$1,660-2,720

Hidden Costs

Expense	Annual Cost	5-Year Total
Developer help when plugins break	\$200-500	\$1,000-2,500
Template updates that break design	\$100-300	\$500-1,500
Total Hidden Costs (5 years)		\$1,500-4,000

Total 5-Year Cost

\$4,540-9,060

And you still don't own your site. Stop paying, and it's gone.

The Hand-Coded Alternative Over 5 Years

Now let's look at what a bespoke, hand-coded website actually costs. No monthly fees. No plugin subscriptions. No vendor lock-in.

One-Time Investment

Package	Cost
The Digital Storefront (1-3 pages)	\$750-1,200
The Brand Experience (up to 5 pages, most popular)	\$1,500-2,500
The Bespoke Build (unlimited pages, complex integrations)	\$3,000+

What's Included

- → Custom design & development
- → Mobile-first responsive design
- → Performance optimization (sub-2-second load times)
- → WCAG 2.2 accessibility compliance
- → SEO foundation
- → Free hosting on Netlify (\$0/month)
- → Complete ownership — no vendor lock-in

Squarespace (5 years)

\$4,540-9,060

Platform fees	\$1,380-2,340
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Add-ons	\$1,660-2,720
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Hidden costs	\$1,500-4,000
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Hand-Coded (one-time)

\$750-3,000

You own everything	✓
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No monthly fees	✓
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No vendor lock-in	✓
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Your 5-Year Savings

\$1,540-8,310

Plus you own your site, it loads 5× faster, and you never have to worry about plugin updates breaking everything.

The Break-Even Timeline

Here's when the hand-coded approach pays for itself compared to Squarespace Core (\$23/month):

Year 1	Squarespace: \$276 (platform) + \$332 (add-ons) + \$300 (developer help) = \$908 Hand-coded: \$1,500 (one-time build, Brand Experience package) <i>You're slightly ahead with Squarespace in year 1.</i>
Year 2	Squarespace: \$276 (platform) + \$332 (add-ons) + \$300 (fixes) = \$908 Hand-coded: \$0 (you own it) <i>Cumulative: Squarespace \$1,816 vs. Hand-coded \$1,500. You're now ahead.</i>
Year 3	Squarespace: \$908 Hand-coded: \$0 <i>Cumulative: Squarespace \$2,724 vs. Hand-coded \$1,500. You've saved \$1,224.</i>
Year 5	Squarespace: \$4,540 total Hand-coded: \$1,500 total <i>You've saved \$3,040 over 5 years.</i>

The Hidden Cost of Slow Websites

There's one cost we haven't calculated: **lost revenue from slow load times.**

Research shows that websites loading in 1 second have a 40% conversion rate, while those taking 3 seconds drop to 29% — an 11% reduction. The average mobile site takes 8.6 seconds to load.

A hand-coded site loads in 1-2 seconds. For a wellness professional charging \$150 per session, even one additional client per month from faster load times means \$1,800/year in recovered revenue. Over 5 years, that's \$9,000.

The real ROI of a hand-coded site isn't just cost savings — it's revenue recovery.

What You Get With Hand-Coded (That Squarespace Can't Match)

- Sub-2-second load times (vs. 4-8 seconds on Squarespace)
- 100/100 PageSpeed scores (vs. 60-70 on Squarespace)
- Complete ownership — no vendor lock-in
- Custom design that reflects your brand (not a template)
- Built-in security (static files can't be hacked)
- Perfect accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.2)
- No surprise price increases

Ready to see what this means for your business?

If these numbers make sense, let's talk about what a hand-coded site could do for your practice.

[Explore the Hand-Coded Approach →](#)

About the Author

Naoman Saeed is a bespoke web engineer who hand-codes lightning-fast, accessible websites for wellness professionals and artisan makers. He believes the web should be as carefully

crafted as the products and services it represents.

Naoman documents his technical journey and shares insights at trogdyne.com.

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Crafting hand-coded websites for wellness professionals and artisan makers